

Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. Post-modernist writers have argued that:
 - (a) we live in a world of superficial, fragmented images
 - (b) no theory is better than any other: 'anything goes'
 - (c) society has changed and we need new kinds of theory
 - (d) all of the above
2. Scott (1991) introduced the term 'power elite' to describe:
 - (a) the ruling class, or bourgeoisie, who exploit the proletariat
 - (b) a capitalist class dependent on property ownership and advantaged life chances
 - (c) an alignment of classes with shared interests but no state power
 - (d) a state elite whose members are drawn overwhelmingly from a power bloc
3. Structural-Functionalists describe society as:
 - (a) a complex network of interaction at a micro-level
 - (b) a source of conflict, inequality, and alienation
 - (c) an unstable structure of social relations
 - (d) a normative framework of roles and institutions
4. In the traditional hierarchy of status and precedence, which of these members of the upper class are in the right order (from highest to lowest status)?
 - (a) Prime Minister, Archbishop of York, Viscounts of England
 - (b) Marquesses of England, Earls of Great Britain, King's Brothers
 - (c) Esquires, Serjeants of Law, Dukes' Eldest Sons
 - (d) King's Grandsons, Lord High Treasurer, Companions of the Bath
5. Marriage appears to be in decline because:
 - (a) the proportion of people living alone has fallen to 29%
 - (b) many people are cohabiting in long term relationships
 - (c) the upward curve of remarriages compensates for the drop in first marriages
 - (d) all of the above

True / False (10 marks)

Answer True or False

6. True or False: Thatcher's government aimed to provide substantial financial support for single parents, students, and the unemployed.
7. True or False: Sociology's knowledge is derived from various research contexts, ensuring a comprehensive understanding of social phenomena.
8. True or False: Comte's term 'positivism' refers to the precise, scientific study of observable phenomena in society.
9. True or False: Pilcher (1999) identified soap operas as a 'feminine genre' because they depict women as both domesticated and independent.
10. True or False: The market model of state welfare provides universal benefits to all individuals, regardless of their income or needs.

Long Form Response (20 marks)

Answer each question with a clear and complete explanation.

11. Discuss the policies pursued by the New Labour government in the context of educational reform, focusing on the implications of their approach towards failing Local Education Authorities (LEAs).
12. Discuss the strategies employed by the Conservative government of 1979 to diminish the influence of the labour movement, and evaluate the implications of these strategies on workers' rights.

End of Paper